

Course Reflection

This course was both engaging and informative, offering me a comprehensive introduction to software engineering—a field I had limited prior experience with. Despite not intending to pursue a career as a software engineer, I found many of the concepts and practices we studied to be highly applicable to my broader interests in technology and system design.

One of my key takeaways from the class was the value of visual modeling through diagrams. Learning how to create and interpret use case diagrams, sequence diagrams, class diagrams, and activity diagrams gave me a much clearer understanding of how complex systems are structured and how their components interact. These tools are not just helpful for developers, but for anyone involved in planning, managing, or analyzing software systems, including product managers and data scientists.

In addition, the emphasis on software development life cycles, requirement gathering, and design principles deepened my appreciation for the collaborative and iterative nature of building software. I now better understand how planning, communication, and documentation play critical roles in the success of any project, especially when multiple stakeholders are involved.

Overall, CSC 431 helped me develop a new perspective on how software is built and maintained. I am confident that the foundational skills and methodologies I learned in this course will continue to benefit me, whether I am working with development teams, designing user-facing tools, or engaging in systems thinking in other domains.